

China Property

China Housing Survey: subdued sentiment in tier 1 cities

Housing purchase intention weakened in tier 1 cities

UBS Evidence Lab's latest China Housing survey of 2,500 respondents across mainland China (28 Oct-18 Nov 2025; > [Access Dataset](#)) shows a subdued intention to buy property over the next two years in tier 1 and 2 cities, compared with the survey in Sep 2024, while sentiment has improved in tier 3 cities ([Figure 2](#)). We attribute this to 1) accelerated price decline in high tier cities, especially since Q325; 2) increasing completion of social housing in tier 1 cities. This is evidenced by the survey results of more respondents having a paper loss on properties in tier 1 cities ([Figure 6](#)), with average price decline of 6% vs the initial purchase prices. Moreover, more respondents in tier 1 cities choose to delay home purchase due to rental housing, whilst there is limited impact in tier 3 cities. In addition, the intention to sell properties has increased, suggesting more downward price pressure from secondary home owners. As a cross-check, secondary listings in 50 cities (another data point to gauge property price expectations) increased by 11% YoY as of end Dec 2025 ([Figure 5](#)), widening from single digit in 1H25. This is consistent with [our sector outlook published in Nov 2025](#), where we forecast a 10%/5% YoY decline for secondary property price and new home sales in 2026/27, respectively.

The top three factors that boost confidence

The top 3 factors that boost household confidence to buy properties are: 1) lower mortgage rates; 2) job promotion/salary increment; and 3) lower down-payment requirements ([Figure 20](#)). This is in line with our [sector outlook](#), where we highlighted the mortgage rate cut is one of the key measures to property price stabilization, and a substantial mortgage cut by over 130bp or a mortgage subsidy of 130bp on existing mortgage balance (Rmb38trn) is needed to motivate households' purchase intention, so that rental yield of tier 1 cities (1.8%) can match with their average commercial mortgage rate (3.1%). On the other hand, completion risk remains the primary element that diminishes household confidence in purchasing properties (with the top 3 factors being incomplete construction, sluggish economic growth and higher down-payment requirements) ([Figure 21](#)). Despite 7.5mn units completion of suspended projects as of end 2025, we expect ensuring completion remains the critical priority for the government, as it fosters social stability and reinstates confidence in new home sales.

Macro findings and implications

The survey shows purchase intention and overall sentiment remained weak albeit slightly less bad than previous low levels, while elevated expectation for future property price declines may continue weighing on property sales and household consumption. There is notable divergence among city tiers, with sharp sentiment deterioration in tier 1 cities and marginal albeit fragile improvement in tier 3 cities. We believe further mortgage rate cuts, enhanced financing support for both developers and house buyers, and measures to address the bottlenecks in the destocking scheme will be necessary. Further declines in property sales and prices could trigger additional policy easing. We expect the PBC to cut policy rates by 10-20bp in 2026, which could lead to 30-40bp mortgage rate cuts. Further fiscal subsidies on mortgage loans are possible but face various policy challenges for now. We also expect more relaxation of home purchase restrictions in tier-1 cities (especially Shanghai and Beijing). Overall, we expect China's property downturn to continue in 2026-20, likely with smaller declines and less of a drag on growth. See more discussions in our macro takeaway report and [China outlook](#).

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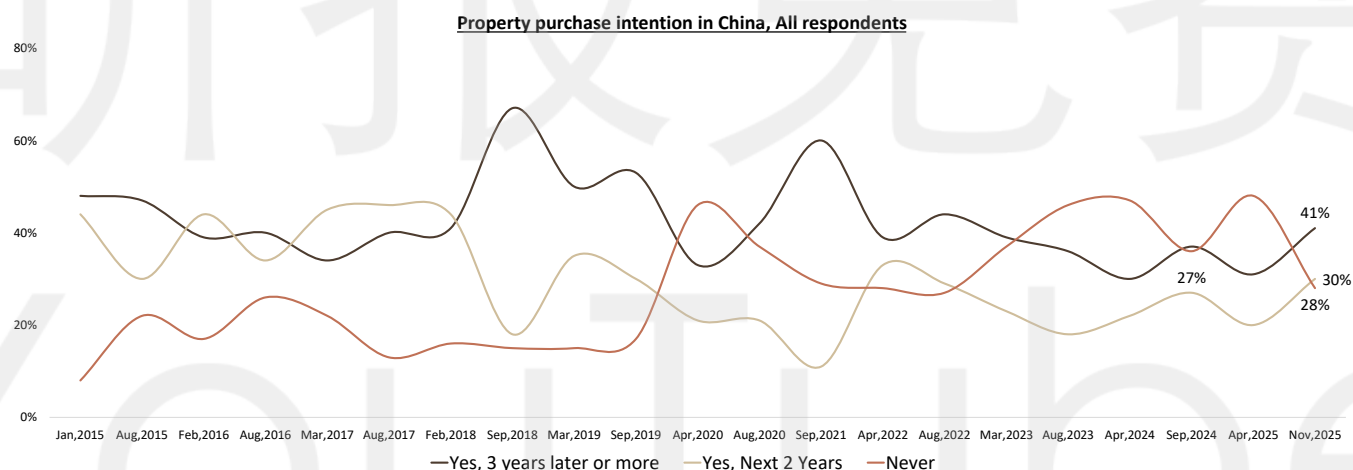
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UBS Evidence Lab's latest China Housing Survey

UBS Evidence Lab's latest China Housing survey canvassed 2,500 respondents across mainland China (28 October-18 November 2025; > [Access Dataset](#)). Whilst the number of respondents who have intention to buy property in the next two years saw a slight YoY increase from 27% in Sept 2024 to 30% in Nov 2025, we think this is due to the low sentiment base in Sept 2024, which is before the end Sept 2024 policy release on property market stabilization. Note: When analysing the survey results, we suggest to compare the purchase intention on a YoY basis to avoid the seasonality.

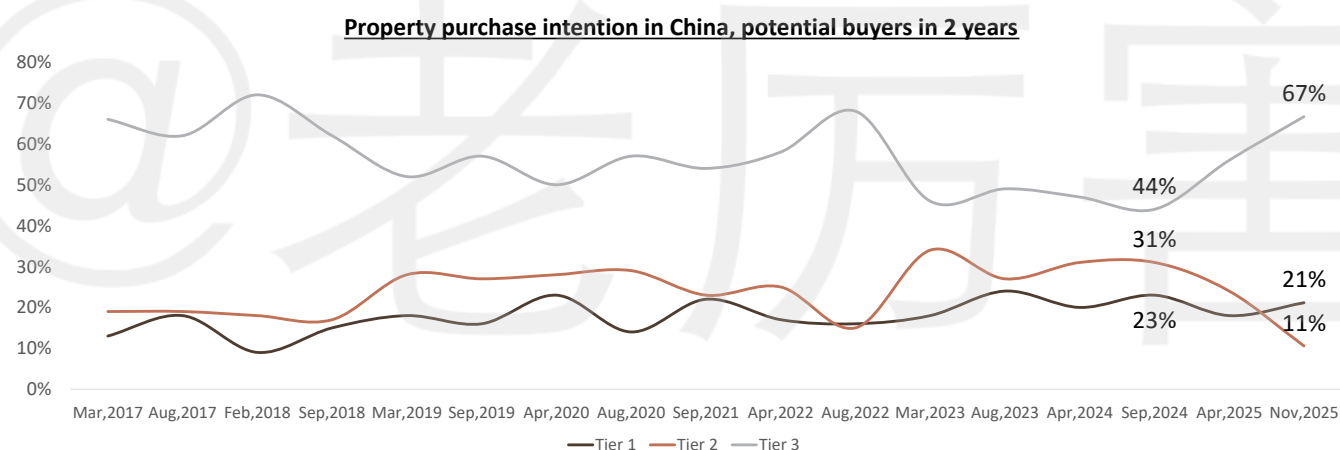
Figure 1: Respondents' intention to buy property in the next two years has improved slightly to 30% in Nov 2025, compared to last year of 27%



Source: UBS Evidence Lab (> [Access Dataset](#))

Weakened purchase intention in tier 1 and 2 cities. For respondents planning to buy property within two years, their purchase intention for property in tier 3 cities increased from 44% in Sept 2024 to 67% in Nov 2025, which might be driven by less incremental paper loss on properties in tier 3 cities. However, that in tier 1 cities has decreased from 23% to 21%, and tier 2 cities has decreased from 31% to 11%.

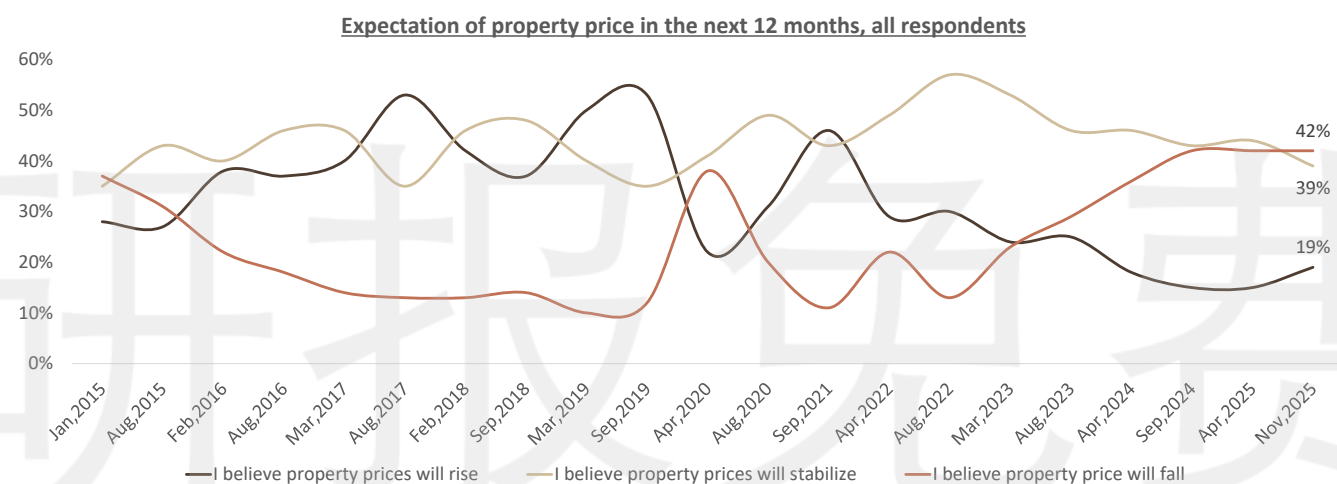
Figure 2: Property purchase intention in tier 1 and 2 cities decreased to 21% and 11% respectively



Source: UBS Evidence Lab (> [Access Dataset](#))

The survey indicated a weak property price expectation. We found that overall, the number of respondents who believe property price will fall in the next 12 months remain the majority at 42%, flattish compared to Sept 2024 and Apr 2025. This is in line with [our sector outlook note published in November 2025](#), where we expect two years of downcycle in 2026-27, and forecast a 10%/5% YoY decline for secondary property price and new home sales in 2026/27, respectively.

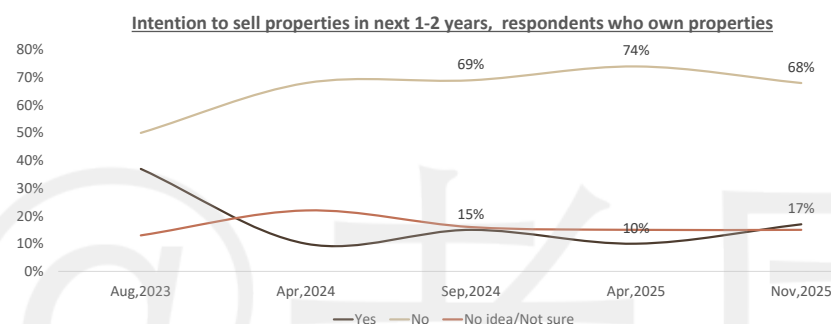
Figure 3: Majority of respondents expect property price will fall



Source: UBS Evidence Lab ([Access Dataset](#))

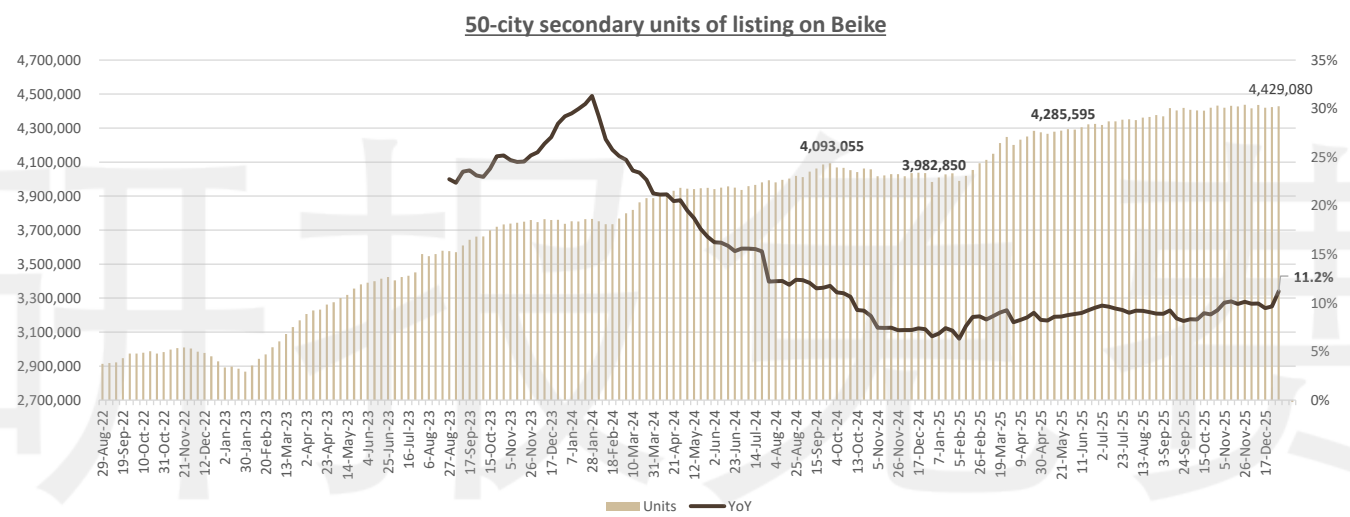
More selling pressure from home owners. Compared with the previous survey in April 2025, the number of respondents planning to sell property in the next one to two years edged up from 10% to 17% , and home owners not planning to sell have decreased from 74% to 68% in November 2025. This suggests more selling pressure from the secondary market and a weakened confidence from the home owner. To cross check, BEKE's 50-city secondary listings have increased by 11.2% YoY to 4.4mn units as of end December 2025, accelerating from 6-9% growth in the first three quarters in 2025. This is consistent with households' expectations of a downward property price trend.

Figure 4: Number of respondents planning to sell property in the next two years has increased in November 2025 vs. April 2025



Source: UBS Evidence Lab ([Access Dataset](#)). Respondents include those who own properties.

Figure 5: Secondary listings across 50 cities up 11.2% YoY as of end-2025

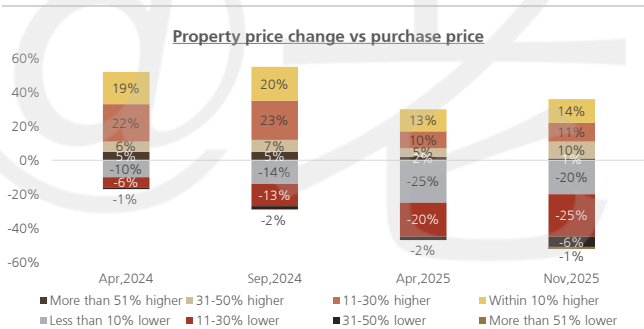


Source: BEKE, UBS Evidence Lab. Note: YTD refers to 11 June 2025.

Tier 1 cities experienced more property price decline. In this round of survey, we observed that respondents who reported having a paper loss on properties have increased from 47% in Apr 2025 to 52% in Nov 2025, which is mainly contributed by the property decline in tier 1 cities. For respondents who own properties in tier 1 cities, those having a paper loss on properties have increased from 37% in Apr 2025 to 55% in Nov 2025. The average property price change vs the initial purchase price is -6% in Nov 2025, compared to +3% average in Apr 2025. Similarly, in tier 2 cities, we saw more respondents reported having a paper loss at 56%, compared to 47% in last survey, whereas tier 3 cities trend was largely stable at 51%, compared to 48% in last survey.

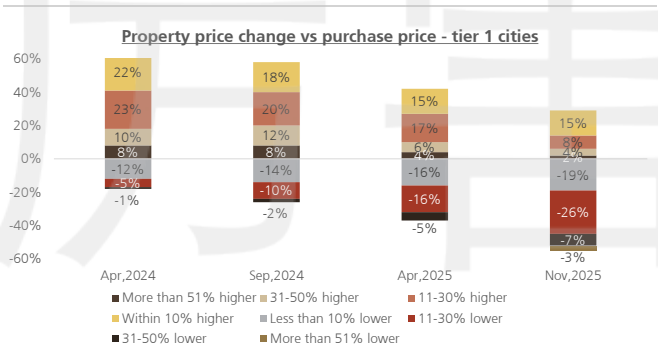
This is in line with the secondary property price decline trend that tier 1 cities have experienced accelerated price decline since July 2025 (Figure 10). We think this is due to 1) muted policy responses in Q325 and fading policy effect of Sept 2024 market stabilization call; 2) relatively high transaction volume in tier 1 cities that contributes to a corrective property price decline vs lower tier cities; 3) rising completion of social housing supply in tier 1 cities in 2025 that attracted more residents to renting instead of buying (we discussed this in details in our [sector outlook note](#)) ; 4) media commentary on BEKE pushing home owners to cut property price to facilitate transactions.

Figure 6: More respondents reported a paper loss



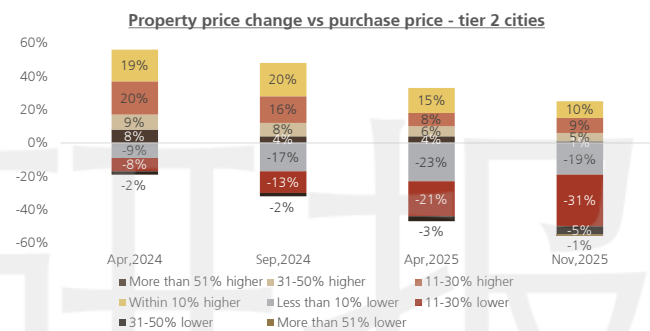
Source: UBS Evidence Lab ([Access Dataset](#)). Respondents include those who own properties.

Figure 7: ... especially in tier 1 cities



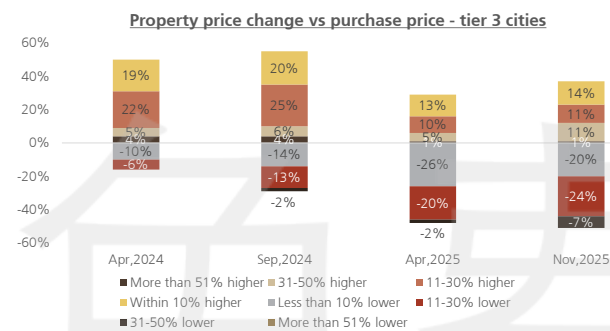
Source: UBS Evidence Lab ([Access Dataset](#)). Respondents include those who own properties.

Figure 8: Tier 2 cities also saw increased paper loss on properties



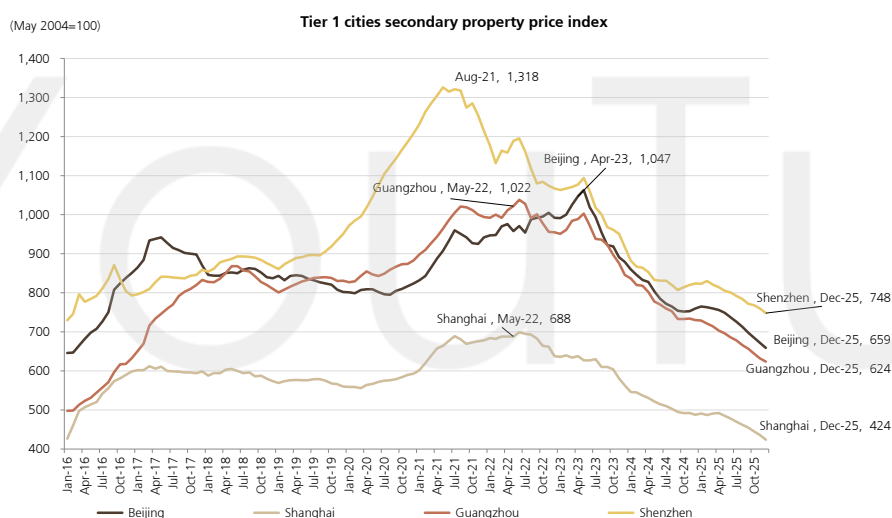
Source: UBS Evidence Lab ([Access Dataset](#)). Respondents include those who own properties.

Figure 9: ...while tier 3 cities were largely stable



Source: UBS Evidence Lab ([Access Dataset](#)). Respondents include those who own properties.

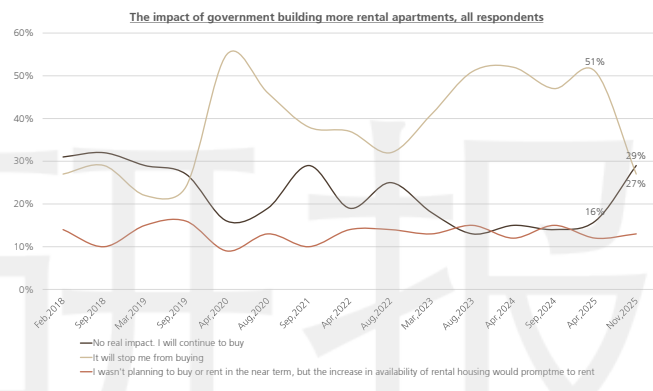
Figure 10: Tier 1 cities saw accelerated secondary property price decline since July 2025



Source: Centaline.

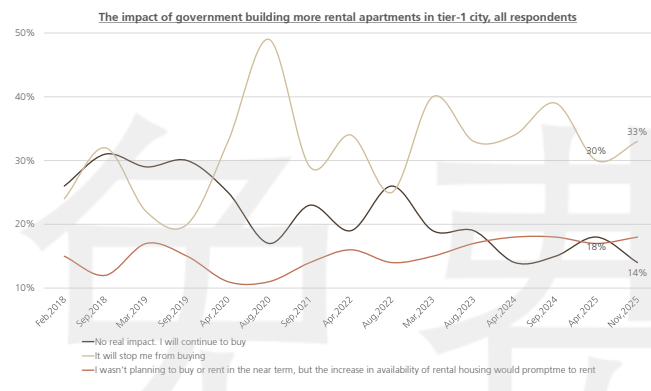
Rental housing would hinder home purchase decisions in tier 1 cities. Compared to the last survey in Apr 2025, respondents who delay housing purchase intention due to more social rental housing have increased from 30% to 33%, while tier 2 and 3 cities saw a decline in trend. We attribute this to 1) increasing completion of social housing in 2025 in tier 1 cities ([Figure 15](#) - [Figure 18](#)) ; 2) wide gap of 130bps between average rental yield (1.8%) and mortgage rate (3.1%) in tier 1 cities, which hinders home buyers.

Figure 11: Less impact of rental housing on home purchase intention



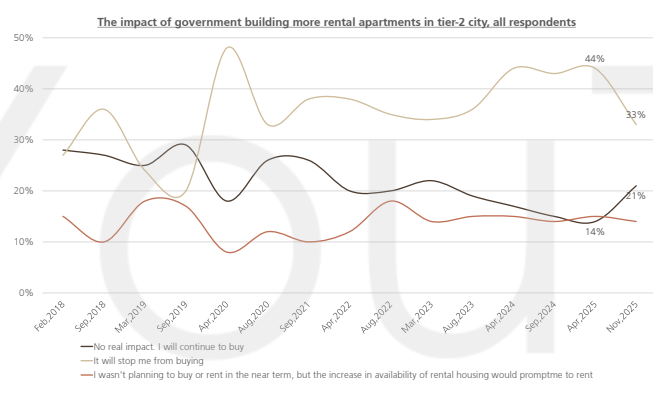
Source: UBS Evidence Lab ([Access Dataset](#)). Respondents include those who own properties.

Figure 12: More impact of rental housing on home purchase intention in tier 1 cities



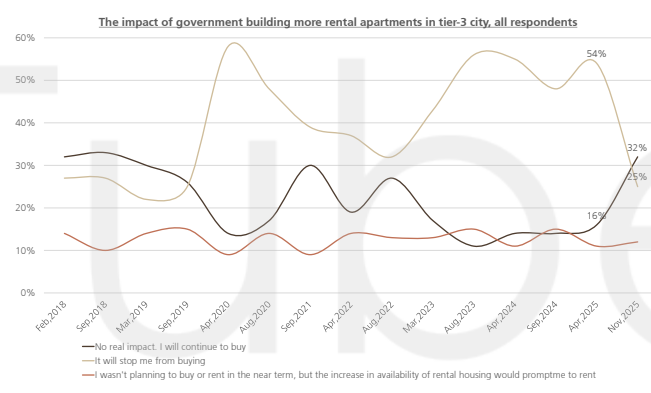
Source: UBS Evidence Lab ([Access Dataset](#)). Respondents include those who own properties.

Figure 13: ... less impact in tier 2 cities



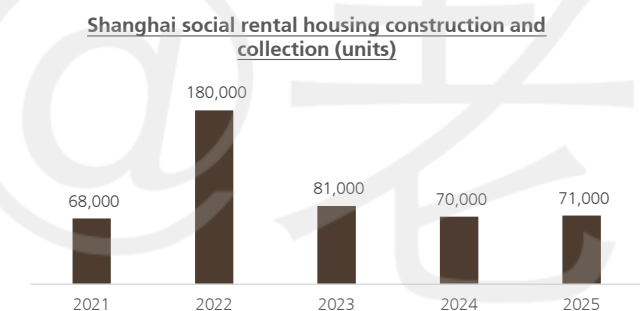
Source: UBS Evidence Lab ([Access Dataset](#)). Respondents include those who own properties.

Figure 14: ... less impact in tier 3 cities



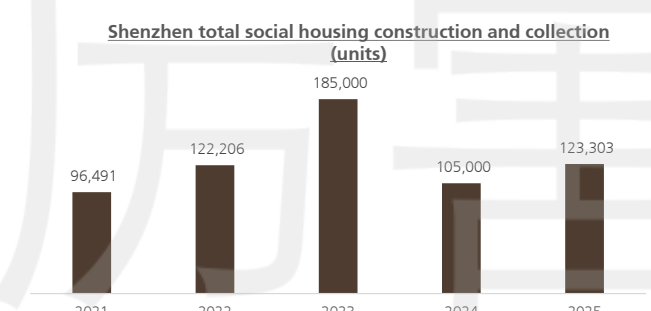
Source: UBS Evidence Lab ([Access Dataset](#)). Respondents include those who own properties.

Figure 15: Shanghai social rental housing construction and collection target remains high in 2025



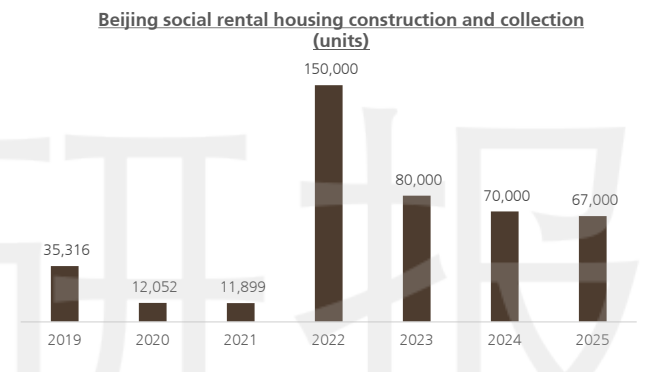
Source: Shanghai Housing Management Bureau, UBS.

Figure 16: Shenzhen has more than halved the social housing construction and collection target in 2025



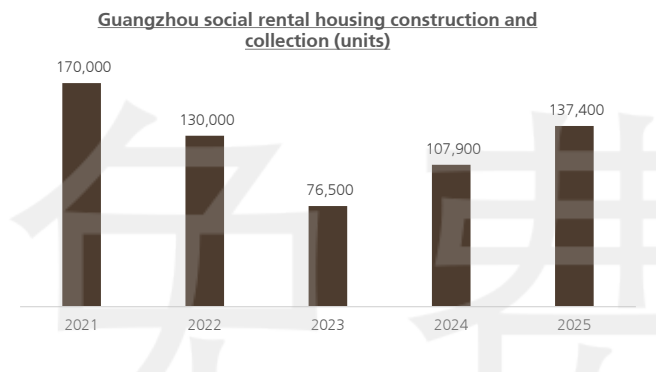
Source: Shenzhen MoHURD, UBS.

Figure 17: Beijing has over-achieved social rental housing target in 2025



Source: Beijing MoHURD, UBS.

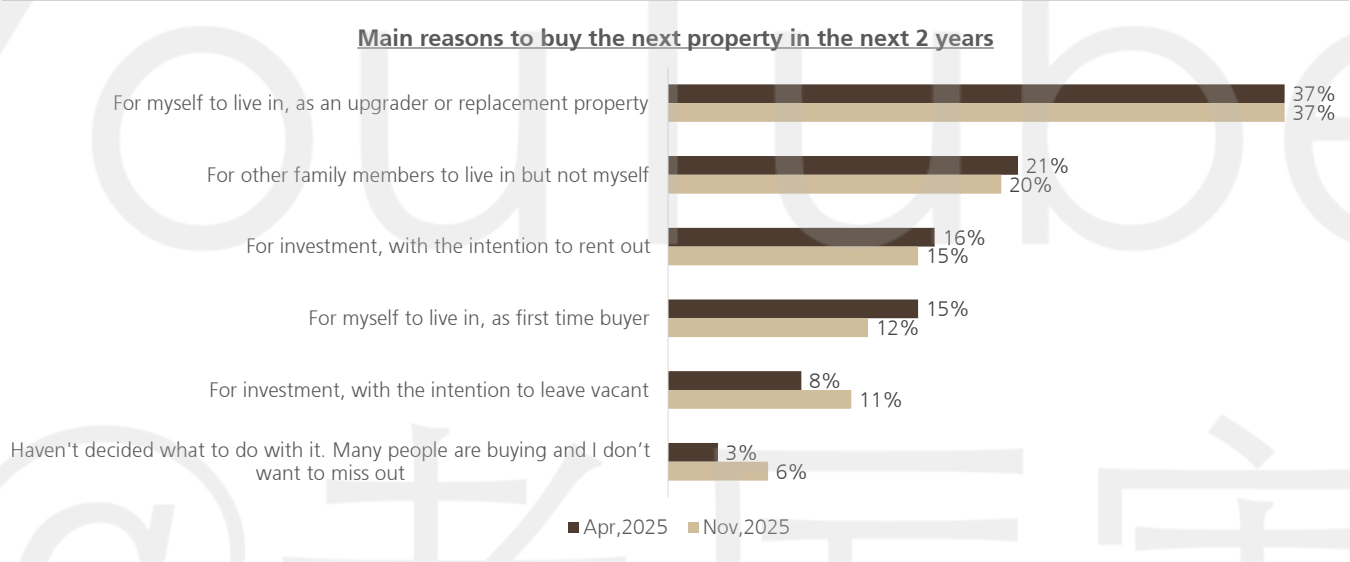
Figure 18: Guangzhou also recorded high completion of social rental housing in 2025



Source: Guangzhou MoHURD, UBS.

Upgrading demand is the main driver of home purchases. Compared with April 2025, upgrading demand remains the top reason to buy a property in the next two years (29% in Sept 2024 vs. 37% in April and Nov 2025), while investment demand remains low at 15%.

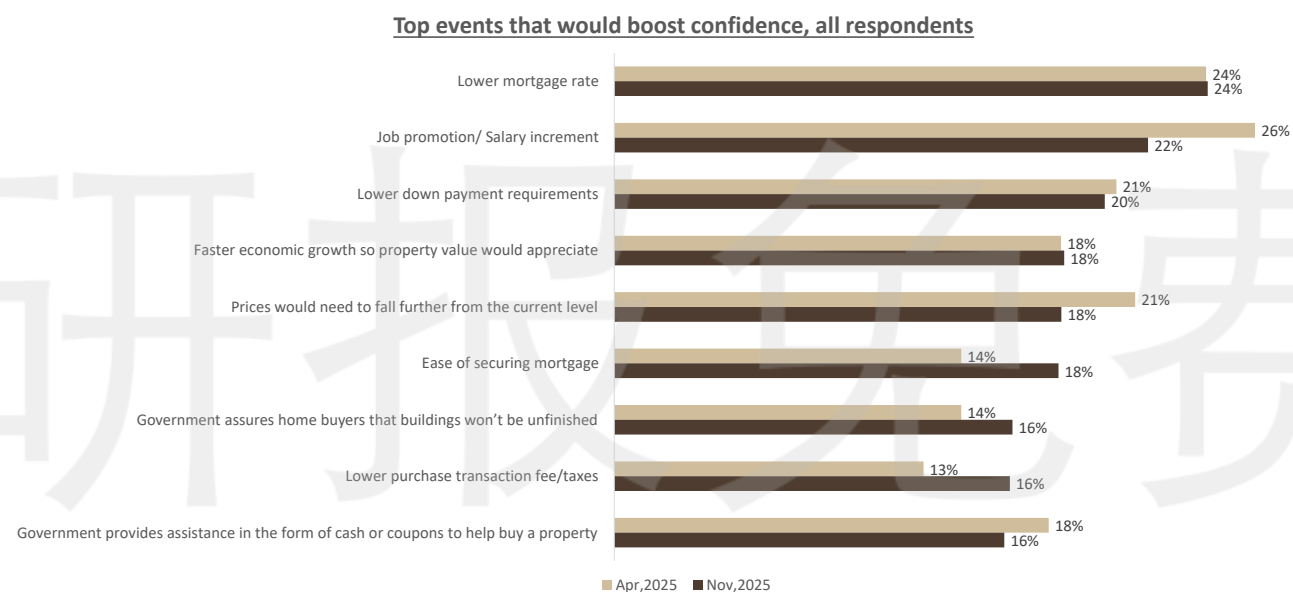
Figure 19: Housing upgrade as the top reason to buy the next property



Source: UBS Evidence Lab ([Access Dataset](#)), respondents who have the purchase intention in the next 2 years.

What are the key events to boost households' purchase confidence? Respondents said lower mortgage rates, job promotion/salary increment and lower down-payment requirements are the top three events that boost their confidence. This is in line with our sector outlook note, where we highlighted the mortgage rate cut is one of the key measures to property price stabilization, and a substantial mortgage cut by over 130bp or a mortgage subsidy of 130bp on existing mortgage balance (Rmb38trn) is needed to motivate households' purchase intention, so that rental yield of tier 1 cities (1.8%) can match with their average commercial mortgage rate (3.1%).

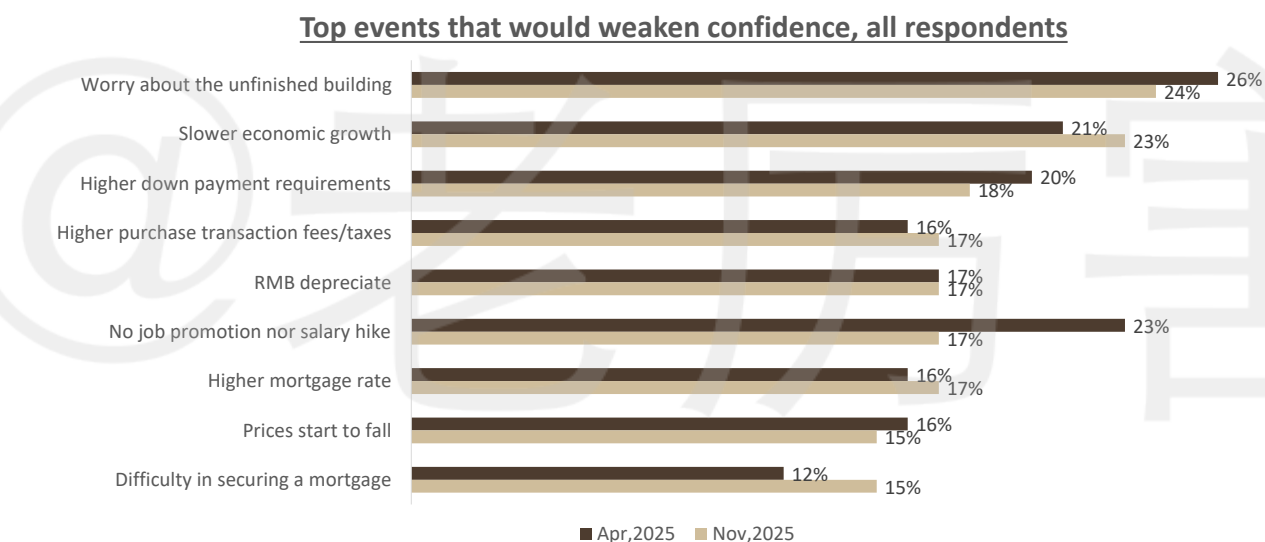
Figure 20: Job promotion/salary increment as factors to boost confidence



Source: UBS Evidence Lab ([Access Dataset](#))

Unfinished building remains the top factor that reduces confidence. Unfinished building, slow economic growth and higher down payment requirements are the top three factors that reduce confidence. The concern level for unfinished construction softened further to 24% compared with 26% in April 2025. That is consistent with MoHURD's announcement that 7.5mn of sold but unfinished properties have been completed and delivered to home buyers as of 2025, although housing completion remains the key task of the government. In the meantime, the concern level of slower economic growth increased from 21% to 23%, suggesting the macro economy growth is the key to drive home sales.

Figure 21: Top three factors that reduce confidence – unfinished construction, no job promotion/salary hike and higher down payment requirements



Source: UBS Evidence Lab ([Access Dataset](#))

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We base our valuations of China's property developers on PE or P/BV multiples.

We believe key downside risks related to the Chinese property market include: 1) government administrative policies that restrict demand and mortgage lending; 2) tight financing for China's developers; 3) lower-than-expected residential growth in China's economy.

We believe key upside risks include: 1) material policy loosening that effectively boosts residential property sales, investments and prices to positive YoY growth; 2) large-scale asset disposals at fair prices by some developers to ease liquidity pressures.

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Buy	Stock price expected to rise within three months from the time the rating was assigned because of a specific catalyst or event.	<1%	<1%
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